

This is the Korean company's second phone based on the Google Android OS; and not only have they fixed a lot of issues with their first foray, the fact that they are partnering with Vodafone to market it worldwide gives us hope of its launch here in the near future.

The phone itself looks fantastic and seems like a great entry for those who do not want to opt for the Apple iPhone 3G. The Magic sports a 3.2-inch touchscreen TFT that displays 65K colours at a resolution of 320x480 pixels. Equipped with an accelerometer, there is no keypad on this one – unlike its predecessor, the T-Mobile G1 – and relies, instead, on a virtual keyboard.

Unlike the iPhone, however, it is not operated by a single button. HTC's offering has a great little trackball, like the Blackberry phones, which acts as your cursor. The trackball is flanked by three buttons on each side: the left has buttons to answer a call, open the menu, or go to the home screen; the right offers the option to end calls, zoom in, or go back.

Flipping the phone around, you will meet a 3.15-megapixel camera with autofocus, that offers a maximum resolution of 2048x1536 pixels. While it can record video, the disappointment of the lack of an LED flash is quite difficult to get over.

The device is powered by a Qualcomm MSM 7201A 528 MHz processor, backed up by 192MB RAM and 512MB ROM. For additional disk space requirements, you can always throw in a microSD card to boost your memory.

The Android OS has received an upgrade on the Magic, with Android v1.5 – also known as Cupcake – that is sleeker, faster, and fixes a lot of bugs from the first release. Of course, the entire suite of Google products comes pre-installed on the phone, offering easy access to Gmail, Gtalk, Google Search, Google Maps, YouTube, etc.

One of the major flaws of the HTC Magic, though, is the lack of a 3.5-mm port for headphones. If the device is being touted as a fun, entertainment phone, the least of the requirements is the ability to connect your own headphones to it. Instead of a 3.5-mm port, the packaged earphones connect to a USB port; although reports state that the phone is now coming with a USB-to-3.5mm convertor cable.